

application programming interface (API) functions like `get_option()` or other similar functions, you need to ensure that you introduce `$wpdb` into the function or method using the global keyword.

Make the `$wpdb` object global whenever you write a function that needs to access the database

```
function my_function()  
{  
    global $wpdb;  
    // Function code here  
}
```

By making the `$wpdb` object available to your function, you expose all the properties and methods available to it.

The database properties

Every table and a variety of options are available as properties to be used with the database class. To access these properties, use `$wpdb->{property}` the same way you would use variables.

show_errors

The `show_errors` property is a true or false (also known as Boolean) property. By default it is set to false, but if you want to be able to debug SQL error messages in the process of development, set `show_errors` to true.

`$wpdb->show_errors` should always be set to false in production.

suppress_errors

The `suppress_errors` property is similar to `show_errors` in that it is a Boolean. In addition, it is similar because it is useful for debugging. However, this property pertains to suppressing database errors involved in bootstrapping.

last_error

The `last_error` property is a string that holds the last SQL or bootstrap error. It is useful for debugging, even if `$wpdb->show_errors` is false. By default, it is empty. This is not a log file and is reinitialized every time WordPress loads (page load).

num_queries

Like other properties already mentioned, the `num_queries` property is useful for debugging. It tracks the number of actual (not cached) queries that have been executed up to the moment it is called within WordPress. At